

## Device to alert traffic violations

An innovative electronic device to curb traffic violations has been developed by three students of PES Institute of Technology, Bengaluru – Anudeep S. Mallesh, Sandeep Raveesh and Shivkumar V. Biradar. The 'Real Time Monitoring of Vehicles' device is of the size of a laptop folder and includes a live video stream facility. It has the capability of sensing speed limit and seat-belt violations.

The driver comes to know about the speed limit for different roads with the help of the device. If any driver violates any rules and regulations, the device sends details of the driver to the authorities, enabling them to take a quick action.

## Wireless devices to communicate without battery

A team of researchers led by Indian-origin Shyam Gollakota from the University of Washington has devised a way for wireless devices to communicate without the need for batteries.

Known as Ambient Backscatter, the technology uses wireless signals like television and cell-phone transmissions surrounding us. According to reports, the wireless devices communicate by reflecting these signals and exchanging information through them. The team has designed battery-less wireless devices with attached antennae, which could detect, harness and then reflect television signals. These signals were then picked up by similar devices.

The devices apparently use the wireless signals as both a source of power and a medium for communication. Their usage could range from wearable computers to smart homes.

## Intelligent 'wearable' camera

Ever wanted your camera to click on its own? Well, the intelligent camera is here. OMG Life has announced the launch of Autographer, the world's first intelligent, wearable camera. The company claims that it automatically captures images hands-free, allowing people to live the moment rather than remaining behind the lens.

## World's first stainless steel robot

Greet is world's first ever robot with stainless steel body depicting seven degrees of freedom. Japan's Kawasaki Heavy Industries has developed the bot, which is expected to be used for research related to drugs and other operations performed in the pharmaceutical field, with an aim to computerise these experiments.

## Soon your fingerprints will unlock your iPhone

As per a recently published patent application on USPTO official website, Apple is working on a technology that can unlock your phone by scanning your fingerprint. If the technology is used in smartphones (read iPhones and iPads), the 'Slide To Unlock' functionality will soon be a thing of the past.

## Here comes another Raspberry Pi alternative, Minnowboard

Raspberry Pi's popularity can be understood from the fact that ever since the low-cost board has been released, other companies have followed suit with their versions of Raspberry Pi. The latest name added to the ever-growing list is a similar bare-bones x86 PC named Minnowboard from Chipzilla. It has a similar caseless design that runs Angstrom Linux build.

## Control your eating and smoking habits using this sensor

A research team at the National Taiwan University has designed a new type of sensor that fits on your teeth and silently monitors all that you put into your mouth along with the quantity of food. It then narrates it all to your doctors. The sensor features accelerometers that help in knowing whether you chew, smoke, speak or cough with nearly 94 per cent precision. However, it cannot determine whether the food you are consuming is healthy as it still needs numerous updates.

## Solar headphones to charge your smartphone battery on the go

A new pair of headphones created by audio engineer, Andrew Anderson from Glasgow, UK, will ensure that your phone's battery does not run out on you. Aptly called the OnBeat headphone, the device has a solar cell fitted into the headband and captures the sun's energy while you are on the move. The energy is stored in a pair of Lithium-ion batteries in the ear cups. When a user plugs the jack of the headphone into his device, the stored energy could be used to charge the device.

Autographer is an intelligent automatic camera that can capture thousands of photographs a day through a custom wide-angle lens, enabling users to enjoy without having to pause for photos.

## A solar tent that will charge tablets, phones

Hikers and campers have good news as we have a new product that will keep their gadgets charged even when they are on the move for days at a stretch. Here is a 'solar tent' that will use the sun's energy to charge smartphones, tablets, GPS tools and cameras while keeping you safe from the scorching heat and dust.

The tent is powered by katabatic technology and would be a great companion on a hike. This could be the camping product that many have been waiting for long. Without any extra

burden, it provides more opportunity than a normal tent.

## World's thinnest organic electronic circuit

World's lightest and thinnest organic circuit is finally here. Thanks to Japanese and European engineers, who claim that the latest ultra-thin organic transistor integrated circuits could be used in numerous healthcare applications.

Lighter than a feather, these circuits are currently being developed under supervision of professor Takao Someya and associate professor Tsuyoshi Sekitani of the University of Tokyo. Their project is funded by the Japan Science and Technology Agency (JST) in association with Siegfried Bauer's group at the Johannes Kepler University Linz, Austria.

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